



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Data protection: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-17 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

56 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
ANPDP deliberation treating images as personal data	Did not exist	Images treated as personal data; deliberation no. 04, effective on publication on the Authority's own website, no Journal officiel step; full text now held	ADVANCED
ANPDP — national data-protection authority	Operating; no enforcement decision held (2025-08)	Compliance push on officers, registers and audit logs; still no enforcement decision held	ADVANCED, IN ACTIVITY RATHER THAN IN ENFORCEMENT
Law 18-07 on personal data protection, as amended by Law 25-11	In force, as amended (2025)	In force; officer and breach-notification duties added by the amendment	NO CHANGE
Mandatory in-country data localisation	In force (2024-09)	In force; no global hyperscaler operates in-country	NO CHANGE

Angola

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Amendment opening electoral data	Did not exist	Rejected, leaving the citizen databases and the electoral registers closed to parties and citizens	CLOSED
Published data-protection fines	A 2024 sanctions wave published, with no totals held	Over Kz 600m across two firms, following two earlier fines divulged in September 2025	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection agency	Constituted and sanctioning under the superintendence of the telecommunications minister, with a 2024 wave that included the incumbent telecoms operator	In operation, sanctioning, and now the country's regional data-governance convener, with three of the seven board seats filled, every member removable by presidential decree at any time and without stated grounds, and own revenue from the fines it levies and the fees it charges, of which it retains 60% — revenue onto which a 2021 pay decree moved most of each board member's salary from May 2024	NO CHANGE
Data protection law	In force since 2011, with consent and notification duties, sensitive-data limits and transfer approvals, and prior authorisation dispensed with wherever the processing derives from a statute or decree	In force and unamended, with fines of USD 75,000 to 150,000 and USD 65,000 to 130,000 on individuals, trebled for legal persons and materially cumulated across concurrent contraventions; article 35(6) substitutes a statute or decree for the regulator's authorisation, article 24 does the same for database interconnection, and article 4(2)(a) puts processing under state-secrecy, state-security and judicial-secrecy rules outside the law altogether	NO CHANGE
Judicial oversight regime for state surveillance	In force since April 2020: cellular location and electronic surveillance authorised in writing by the Ministério Público where the premises are private or restricted, and by the head of the police body in urgent cases with notice to the prosecutor within 72 hours	Unchanged; no judicial warrant is required at any stage, execution runs 90 days renewable once for cellular location and successively for electronic surveillance until instruction closes, private persons and businesses must open their own video-surveillance systems to the criminal police in real time or deferred, and the data-protection authority is given knowledge and monitoring of the resulting police database rather than authorisation; separately, no rule states when the intelligence service may obtain identity, biometric or mobility data, and no independent body reviews such requests	NO CHANGE
Video-surveillance licensing regime	In force since December 2021: installations licensed by the minister responsible for public security on an application filed with the National Police, carrying a prior opinion of the data-protection authority, with the police holding the national database of installed systems and carrying out inspection	Unchanged; recordings are erased at 30 days unless a criminal-police or judicial body has requested them, technical specification is mandated down to the camera housing and encryption, and authorisation fees are split 40% to the State, 35% to the National Police and 25% to the data-protection authority, with fines split 40% Treasury, 40% police and 20% authority	NO CHANGE
Data protection law revision	BASELINE NOT HELD	Consultation closed on a revision adding a data-protection officer duty for high-volume processors, stronger oversight and sanction mechanisms, and redenominating fines into local currency; due at the Council of Ministers then the National Assembly	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Benin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection authority	Operating (2025-08)	907 files, 64 control missions, 14 sanctioned cases; no algorithmic-audit tooling or budget	ADVANCED, IN CASELOAD
Enforcement against the electoral agency	BASELINE NOT HELD	Extraneous fields required to be stripped from the electoral roll before publication	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Botswana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate	Did not exist	Portal suspended; a privacy notice published 2026-07-06, an impact assessment completed 2026-07-13, multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan added; no reopening date	ADVANCED
Information and Data Protection Commission	Three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner (2025-07-29)	A commissioner in post, enforcing against non-bank financial institutions in February 2026 and against a government directorate in July 2026	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act No. 18 of 2024	In force, regulator not yet operational (2025-07-29)	In force; first published enforcement against a government body, 2026-07-17	NO CHANGE

Burkina Faso

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection commission	An operating authority with no repressive powers, its standing borrowed from a prime-ministerial compliance campaign	Superseded as data-protection supervisor on the face of the August 2026 votes, never having received the enforcement decrees it asked for in March 2025	CLOSED, SUBJECT TO PROMULGATION
Data protection law of 2026	Did not exist	Voted with processing without consent prohibited and sanctioned, administrative fines indexed to turnover and scaled by gravity, transfer of sensitive data abroad prohibited, use of personal data for commercial prospecting prohibited without prior consent and enforced by administrative sanctions of the regulator without prejudice to court action, and private video-surveillance devices left lawful but framed where they face the public highway	ADVANCED
Merged communication and data-protection authority	Did not exist; the broadcasting regulator and the data-protection commission were separate	A single authority merging the broadcasting regulator created in 1995 and the data-protection commission instituted in 2004, with its own rule-making power and staggered renewal of the first college, the state news agency placing the merger under the revised Constitution of 20 January 2026; no commencement, seat or leadership stated	ADVANCED
Non-profit register decree	A register governed by a 2017 decree with no retention period for the data it holds	Replaced under a 2024 anti-money-laundering law, fixing for the first time a retention period for the data after dissolution and adding donation declarations and intervention-theme fields	ADVANCED
Data protection law of 2021	In force as the operative statute with an annual-reporting duty, and no repressive powers because the implementing decrees were never made	Still the operative text, since the successor voted in August 2026 is not promulgated, and the decrees were never issued in the five years the law ran	NO CHANGE

Burundi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
ARCT injunctions on value-added-service consent	Did not exist	Issued; the consumer association reports no significant improvement two months on, and no sanction is on file	ADVANCED
Data protection authority	Did not exist	Provided for by statute; not on record as operating	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Personal data protection law	No statute	In force: eight chapters, an independent authority, criminal penalties, Malabo-aligned	ADVANCED

Cameroon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Loi n. 2024/017 on personal data protection	In force; no supervisory authority operating	In force; no supervisory authority operating, the promulgated text acquired 2026-07-29	NO CHANGE
Personal data protection authority	Created in law, not established, unfunded	Created in law, not established, unfunded	NO CHANGE

Cape Verde

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Comissao Nacional de Proteccao de Dados	Independent supervisory authority operating from 2015-16, with fining powers and referral of possible criminal matters to the public prosecution; a member of the Global Privacy Assembly	Powers unchanged. The president stated the authority was entering a phase more attentive to digital innovation, and named retention of technical staff as a standing constraint, every technician who started in 2016 having left	NO CHANGE
Data-protection commission appropriation	CVE 36,313,115 for FY2025, appropriated inside the National Assembly's own private budget rather than through any ministerial vote, a 3.0% uplift on CVE 35,255,451 for FY2024, with zero own-source revenue in both years	FY2025 remains the latest established appropriation. Against the fining powers the statute confers, an annual budget of about CVE 36 million is roughly a dozen maximum penalties	NO CHANGE
Judicial police access to the national video-surveillance system	A formal request was made to the Interior Minister in mid-2024; the force had no effective access	Still no effective access. The Justice Minister called the claim justified and said steps were under way with the Interior Ministry, which manages the system, alongside expansion projects in several cities and islands	NO CHANGE
Lei 133/V/2001, general data-protection regime	General regime closely mirroring the EU standard, with administrative fines of CVE 50,000-3,000,000, cessation, blocking and deletion measures, and criminal penalties up to two years; amended in 2013, creating the commission, and in 2021, requiring designation of data-protection officers	Unchanged; no amendment is recorded in the window. A named analyst argued on 2025-04-07 for aligning it with artificial intelligence and adding mechanisms for algorithmic supervision; no bill is held	NO CHANGE

Central African Republic

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection authority	Not established, with the statute vesting its functions in the supervising ministry meanwhile	Not established, eighteen months past the statutory deadline	NO CHANGE
Loi n. 24.001 on personal data protection	In force since January 2024, a comprehensive regime with no supervisory authority and no implementing decree	Unchanged; the law in force and still no implementing decree on file	NO CHANGE

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Law on biometric data in judicial procedures	Did not exist	Adopted, its scope being the collection, processing, retention, use and destruction of biometric data exclusively within judicial and judicial-police procedures	ADVANCED
Ordonnance n 001/PR/2026 reforming the security and electronic certification agency	A cybersecurity and electronic-certification agency, with no data-protection, artificial-intelligence, drone or video-surveillance remit on record	A mandate covering cybersecurity, personal-data protection, electronic-transaction security, cybercrime, protection of the national information space, video-surveillance systems, drones, social media, digital services and artificial-intelligence systems, plus a classification of entities of vital digital importance and expanded investigative and enforcement powers	ADVANCED
General data-protection law and supervisory authority	None enacted and no authority; the base holds no Chadian data-protection statute at any date	None enacted and no authority, with the security agency empowered to administer a regime that does not yet exist	NO CHANGE, ADMINISTERING AGENCY NOW NAMED BUT NO LAW

Comoros

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National personal data protection authority	Provided for in law since 2021-06-29 and not constituted	Still does not exist, its creation financed entirely by external lenders with no domestic appropriation	NO CHANGE, STAND-UP PROCUREMENT ISSUED
Protection of Personal Data Law	In force, aligned to the European regulation, extraterritorial, with seventy-two-hour breach notification, a mandatory data-protection officer and full data-subject rights, and the national authority not constituted	Unchanged, the authority's non-existence restated in the procurement notice of 2026-03-12	NO CHANGE

Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-14	MOVEMENT
National personal data protection commission	A bill approved in council of ministers in July 2024, with no members appointed and the body not constituted	Members appointed and a president, vice-president and rapporteur elected, with powers stated as advising, warning and sanctioning	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-14	MOVEMENT
Loi n. 29-2019 on personal data protection	In force with an incomplete institutional framework and no supervisory authority constituted	In force, its institutional framework completed by a decree of 2025-12-31	NO CHANGE

Cote d'Ivoire

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Register of data-protection officers	Did not exist	Created and named by the minister alongside simplified norms as one of the country's data-protection advances	ADVANCED
Loi n 2013-450 on personal data protection	In force, with the telecoms regulator designated the data-protection authority	In force and unamended, with the regulator confirmed as the authority after the cyber agency's creation; no separable data-protection appropriation exists	NO CHANGE
Compliance and authorisation caseload	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 100 physical data-protection compliance files handled per month immediately before the platform went live	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Djibouti

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Police body-worn cameras	Not on record	In routine use in central Djibouti, with visible wearing and notification protocols and manual or automatic triggers (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Data-protection regime within the Digital Code (156 articles)	In force	In force	NO CHANGE
Prior authorisation for national-identifier and biometric processing	In force	In force; no authorisation on record for the police body-camera fleet (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

DR Congo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Mobile network service in conflict-held eastern territories	One territory centre off all networks from March 2025 because generator fuel could not reach tower sites	Baraka and Fizi telecoms and internet cut for months amid operations against Twiraneho/AFC-M23 near Epupu; humanitarian NGOs' Starlink kits seized on the Baraka mayor's order, closing the last backup channel; rights defenders demand restoration	REGRESSED
National network of data protection officers	Did not exist	A national network live, supported by two civil-society bodies and framed as alignment with the continental convention; the first concrete step under article 262 since 2023	ADVANCED
National data protection authority	Required by article 262 of the code; the decree never drafted or signed and the body non-operational	Still not created; the minister said in March 2026 that structuring a professional network precedes its creation, and it was named again in July as a link in the cybersecurity chain	NO CHANGE
Nationwide social-media restriction	The restriction had ended before the window opened and no acknowledged legal basis was ever stated	No further nationwide restriction recorded to 2026-08-06; the 2025 shutdown count for the country is attributed to the eastern conflict rather than to a national order	NO CHANGE

Egypt

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data-protection compliance guidelines and templates	Did not exist; no regulator guidance is recorded in the base before 2026	Ten guidelines published, covering consent, lawful bases of processing, electronic direct marketing, the data protection officer, officer categories, data users, principles, records of processing activities, licences and permits, and privacy notices, together with breach-notification and records templates	ADVANCED
Personal Data Protection Law 151 of 2020	In force since 2020 but never operationalised, with no executive regulations issued	Operationalised by the Executive Regulations; the law's obligations on purpose limitation, approvals, cross-border transfer licensing, data-protection officer appointment, 72-hour breach notification and guardian consent for under-15s become enforceable from 2026-11-01 at the end of a one-year grace period	ADVANCED
Data-protection enforcement actions	One award on record: the Alexandria Economic Court ordered an operator to pay EGP 10 million in February 2025, on facts from November 2022, after an unconsented SIM replacement	The same single judgment. The base records no regulator decision, fine, registration figure or cross-border-transfer licence issued at any date to 2026-08-06	BASELINE NOT HELD
Personal Data Protection Center	The base carries no dated statement of the Centre's standing, staffing or activity at 2025-08-01; its first appearance in this section's source base is 2025-11-16	Confirmed as the body implementing, monitoring and enforcing the law, running the approvals and cross-border-transfer licensing regime, officer registration and breach receipt; the acting chief executive framed data sovereignty as a strategic necessity at a November 2025 workshop	BASELINE NOT HELD

Equatorial Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-14	MOVEMENT
Data protection law and supervisory authority	Not held	In force since 2016-08-11; gives rights of access, rectification, cancellation, opposition and indemnisation and a sanctions regime running to CFA 15,000,000 for the gravest infractions, but Article 15 leaves the Organo Rector de Proteccion de Datos Personales - and the registry it would run - to a decree the government has never issued; africadataprotection.org's own country page records no supervisory authority publicly identified	ADVANCED

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Advisory guidelines on processing personal health data	Did not exist	In validation; to be published as a regulatory instrument under the Data Protection Act	ADVANCED
Biometric gate passes in schools	Did not exist	Deployed and refused by some teachers and parents on consent and child-data grounds	ADVANCED
Eswatini Data Protection Authority	Office not operationalised three years after the Act took effect (2025-07)	Operating: an awareness campaign, a registration deadline of 31 March 2026, one concluded complaint and one investigation into a ministry	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Home Affairs publication of unblurred national identity documents	Did not exist	Under investigation by the data protection authority	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act 2022	In force, authority not operationalised	In force; fines to E5,000,000 or 2% of annual turnover	NO CHANGE

Ethiopia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data sharing arrangement under the health memorandum	Did not exist	The two governments intend to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on the memorandum's long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, expected to run two years beyond the five-year term and to be designed compatibly with Ethiopia's agreements with other countries and with regional and global bodies; no text is published, and the State Department briefly posted a subset of the memoranda in March 2026, then removed access and published none of the related agreements	ADVANCED
Development Bank of Ethiopia Information Disclosure Policy	Did not exist	In force: client credit information and other named categories are exempt from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the Bank, its stakeholders or national interest; the Bank may also decline requests requiring it to create records it does not already hold	ADVANCED
Personal Data Protection Proclamation 1321/2024	In force, no secondary directives (2025-08)	In force; directives still unissued and the Authority has yet to enforce	NO CHANGE

Gabon

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Autorite de protection des donnees a caractere personnel	Created by article 7 of the 2023 statute, with no dated act of the authority held	Two dated acts on record - supervised destruction of unsuccessful bidders' files on 2026-01-20 and pre-commissioning compliance for the data centre on 2026-06-09	ADVANCED
Biometric prohibition and its derogation route	Outright prohibition in force, with the derogation cross-reference defective	Outright prohibition in force, with the derogation cross-reference defective	NO CHANGE
Data-protection funding levy	1,000 FCFA per person per year on a 40/60 split	1,000 FCFA per person per year on a 40/60 split	NO CHANGE
Loi n 025/2023 on the protection of personal data	In force and binding from publication, with no transitional window	In force and binding from publication, with no transitional window	NO CHANGE

Gambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025	No comprehensive data-protection law; the Bill was before the National Assembly (2025-08)	Enacted, with extraterritorial scope, seven lawful bases, a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (2025-12)	ADVANCED

Ghana

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Commission	Operating under the 2012 Act, with a new governing board sworn in that day and tasked with a national data-governance framework	Operating, with 2026 declared a year of enforcement and a size-banded fee schedule in force from 2026-02-02	ADVANCED
United States health data-sharing agreement	Did not exist	Offered and refused: a five-year agreement that, on the data-protection regulator's account, covered not only health data sets but metadata, dashboards, reporting tools, data models and data dictionaries, gave ten United States entities access requiring no prior Ghanaian approval, required 25 years of citizens' health records, and settled disputes under United States law against US\$109m subject to congressional appropriation	CLOSED, REFUSED BEFORE SIGNATURE
Data Protection Act 2012	In force as the sole general data-protection statute, with controllers and processors the regulated class	In force and unamended, with a draft replacement published during 2025 and not enacted	NO CHANGE
Data-protection enforcement actions	No enforcement figures published	Still no fine, prosecution or registered-controller count published, twelve months on	NO CHANGE
Upgrade of the data-protection regulator to an authority	Announced by the minister at the board swearing-in, with no bill	Announced, with no bill, no timetable and no further mention on file in twelve months	NO CHANGE
Draft Data Protection Act 2025	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would require domestic storage of data critical to national security, civil registration and sensitive personal data including children's, biometric, health and genetic data	Baseline not held

Guinea

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Consumer-protection conditions on NimbaPay	Did not exist	Twelve conditions published; unanswered	ADVANCED
Data protection law	Not held	Statute held (Loi L/2016/037/AN, 2016): covers processing of personal data by individuals, firms and public institutions and the related offences; provisions known only from ANSSI's own summary, as the 57-page scan carries no machine-readable text layer	BASELINE NOT HELD

Guinea-Bissau

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Data Governance and Protection Policy (decree)	Draft decree approved by Council of Ministers 2025-07-10; not confirmed published or in force	Unchanged; no further movement on file	NO CHANGE

Kenya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Communications Authority escalated consumer complaints	362 complaints in October to December 2025	670 escalated complaints in April to June 2026, up from 563 in the prior quarter, with 548 or 82% resolved; data services drew 195 complaints against 44 for voice, data billing and charges was the largest single category at 75, and the Authority separately logged 19 data-breach complaints	REGRESSED
Constitutional Petition E095 of 2026	Did not exist	Decided, awarding 11 petitioners KES 900,000 each for a sustained and systematic compromise of subscriber data	ADVANCED
Gambling regulator investigation into three licensed operators	Did not exist	Open, with the criminal investigations directorate requesting the regulator's entire record on the licensees back to 2018	ADVANCED
ODPC Data Protection Services appropriation	No separately visible appropriation	KSh 917.3m appropriated in the original estimates, projected to KSh 1,328m by 2028/29	ADVANCED
ODPC Guidance Note on Artificial Intelligence	Did not exist	36-page draft reading Part VI of the Data Protection Act onto AI, requiring a lawful transfer basis and a documented adequacy assessment before any transfer to an offshore AI processor, registration with the Office of every entity deploying AI on Kenyan data subjects' data, a data protection impact assessment before any high-risk deployment, and obligations mapped across a seven-stage AI lifecycle that applies to procured systems as to built ones	ADVANCED
ODPC Guidance Note on Emerging Technologies	Did not exist	31-page draft covering the internet of things, cloud, blockchain, biometric recognition classified as one-to-one, one-to-many and many-to-many, extended reality and connected vehicles	ADVANCED
ODPC Guidance Note on Privacy-Enhancing Technologies	Did not exist	38-page draft reading adoption of privacy-enhancing technologies as a statutory obligation under privacy by design	ADVANCED
US-Kenya Health Cooperation Framework	Did not exist	Signed 2025-12-04 for a five-year term, with US\$1,631,470,000 of planned United States support across FY2026-FY2030 including US\$175,000,000 for health data systems; frozen by injunction that month, the suspension of the data-transfer component reversed on appeal in May 2026, and a final ruling reported due at end-October 2026. The framework's US\$2.5bn headline value, used in press and litigation coverage, is this same US\$1,631,470,000 of planned US support plus Kenya's own pledged increase in domestic health expenditure (Framework paragraph 6.1.2, approximately US\$850m to FY2029/30 per the US Department of State's own announcement of the signing) — not a competing figure	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act 2019	In force, with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner as statutory regulator	In force, with the regulator now stretching its cross-border-transfer duties to reach offshore AI processing	NO CHANGE
ODPC enforcement caseload and penalties	7,128 complaints received and 215 determinations issued as of March 2025	Same statement; no later caseload, determination count or penalty total published	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED
ODPC five-year privacy plan	Launched at KES 12.6bn over five years	Launched, with no spend, milestone or progress statement on file since	NO CHANGE
Betting and gaming firms registered with the ODPC	BASILINE NOT HELD	15 of 224 fully registered as both controller and processor, with 185 unregistered and given 40 days or licence cancellation	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Cybercrime losses, regulator estimate	BASELINE NOT HELD	At least KSh 29bn a year	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Bilateral health agreement with the United States and its data-sharing instrument	Did not exist	Signed; the State Department briefly published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act 2011	In force, unamended	In force, unamended as at 2026-03-23	NO CHANGE
Data Protection Commission	Provided for in law, unappointed	Provided for in law, unappointed as at 2026-03-23	NO CHANGE

Liberia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Privacy enforcement against telecom operators	Did not exist; no privacy penalty on record (2025-08)	LRD 4m fine (US\$21,900 at the time, per the source) imposed by the telecoms regulator rather than under data-protection law (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Personal Information Act (data protection bill)	Referred to a House committee in June 2025, unpassed, with no national data authority (2025-08)	Still before the legislature and unpassed, with no data-protection authority in existence (2026-05)	NO CHANGE

Libya

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Tax Police	Not active	Activated for oversight and compliance	ADVANCED
Data-protection law	None in force	None in force; targeted for 2026 by the AI strategy	NO CHANGE

Madagascar

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Commission Malagasy de l'Informatique et des Libertes (CMIL)	Provided for, not constituted	Provided for, not constituted; no later account held	NO CHANGE
Data-protection law (loi n 2014-038)	In force, unenforced	In force, unenforced	NO CHANGE

Malawi

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Authority within the regulator	Designated under the Act but not stood up; the government was tendering advisory and technical consultancy to produce the unit's organogram and governance charter, staffing, operations manual, monitoring and enforcement framework, and a business plan targeting cost recovery within five years	Operating as a unit inside the regulator with a named head of data protection and a stated implementation framework; no organogram, enforcement record or registration data is published	ADVANCED
Draft Data Protection Regulations, Guidelines and Registration Fees	No subsidiary data-protection instruments were made; drafting of regulations, codes of practice, guidelines, a priced service list and a scale of fines was still out to tender under an acceleration-project consultancy in October 2025	The regulator has published draft regulations, guidelines and a turnover-based registration fee schedule ranging from MWK 50,000 for small and medium enterprises to MWK 7 million for the largest controllers and processors of significant importance, and consulted stakeholders before finalisation; no commencement date is on record	ADVANCED
Separation of the data protection authority and the emergency response team from the regulator	Both bodies sat inside the regulator under the Data Protection Act; no separation plan is on record	The regulator states it intends to establish both as independent institutions, with World Bank technical assistance and capacity building; no legislative vehicle, timetable or funding model is on record	ADVANCED

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Autorite de Protection des Donnees a caractere Personnel	Reviewing about 2,000 declaratory files; one 5m FCFA fine and more than 100 formal notices in 2025	More than 1,000 files before a ten-day session, with a Segou regional antenna open	ADVANCED
Mandatory lease-declaration decree	None published	Draft; no adoption on record	ADVANCED
Benin and Mali data-protection cooperation	Agreed (2025-04)	Agreed; no joint action published since	NO CHANGE
Loi n2013-015 on personal data protection	In force	In force and the stated basis for the authority's sanctions	NO CHANGE

Mauritania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection authority	Established, with a 2023-2026 plan	Established; no decision, register, enforcement action or annual report is held	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data protection law and enforcement record	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force since 22 July 2017, requiring APD-approved codes of conduct and free, unambiguous consent for personal-data processing, covering both manual and electronic processing; the authority runs monthly ordinary meetings and sensitisation days for ministries, telecom operators and financial institutions; no enforcement decision, register entry, sanction or annual report is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Office enforcement	Independent office enforcing the 2017 Act, with no published enforcement volume (2025-08)	About 3,000 enforcement actions a year, 99% resolved amicably, chief data officers mandated, and administrative fines being added by amendment (2026-05)	ADVANCED
European Union adequacy assessment	Not stated as a pursuit (2025-08)	Being pursued with full alignment of the law to the European regulation; no application date, assessment stage or decision is published (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Communications interception	Described in Parliament as large-scale interception running since 2017 without judicial oversight, wired into major operators and accessed by counter-terrorism and national security units; no reform instrument on record (2025-08)	Unchanged: no reform instrument, inquiry outcome or judicial-authorisation requirement has been published, and leaked recordings continue to test the framework (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
Data Protection Act 2017	In force, GDPR-aligned and enforced by an independent office (2025-08)	Unchanged: amendments were committed in July 2026 with no text, timetable or introduction date, and the Act is not among the 58 Acts the omnibus amends, so the year's expanded inter-agency data sharing arrives with no matching safeguards amendment (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data-protection cooperation memorandum with Portugal	Did not exist	Signed; exchange of information and technical expertise on artificial intelligence, synthetic media and digital violence	ADVANCED
Facial-recognition case-by-case authorisation regime	Moratorium in force to 2020-12-30	Case-by-case prior-authorisation regime in force, preserving sectoral authorisations D-108-EUS/2020 and D-126-EUS/2020, and conditioning future authorisation on routing through a national trusted-third-party identity system; the CNDP flags controllers building their own biometric databases, sometimes hosted abroad	ADVANCED
National responsible-artificial-intelligence platform	Did not exist	Agreement signed to build national platforms on large language models incorporating Moroccan language, culture, legal framework and digital identity; no platform, budget or delivery date on record eleven months later	ADVANCED
Registre National de la Protection des Donnees a caractere Personnel (RN-PDP)	Did not exist	Public register operating under loi 09-08 articles 45-50	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Smart patrol vehicles with live facial recognition	Shown at police open days in Rabat, May 2026; not in service	In field service in Rabat with Casablanca and Tangier announced next; live facial recognition, automated number-plate reading and in-vehicle access to the central database	ADVANCED
Data-protection deliberation on video surveillance	Hearings decided 2025-03-21; no draft published (2025-08)	No deliberation published at 2026-08-09; the commission treats facial recognition on the public highway as an open question	NO CHANGE
Facial recognition for benefit proof of life	Permitted case by case on prior authorisation since 2020-07-29 (2025-08)	Same; no authorisation count or revocation record is held	NO CHANGE
Facial recognition for remote bank account opening	Permitted case by case on prior authorisation since 2020-04-23 (2025-08)	Same; no authorisation count, revocation or migration record is held	NO CHANGE

Mozambique

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Sharing Agreement under the health memorandum	Did not exist	Signed by the two governments on the same day as the memorandum and not annexed to it, so neither its term, its pathogen or genetic-sequence scope nor any transfer trigger can be read from the instrument that penalises failure to fulfil it; the State Department briefly posted a subset of the memoranda in March 2026, then removed access and published none of the related agreements, and a suit for their release was unresolved at 2026-04-02	ADVANCED
National data protection authority	No data regulatory authority, with INTIC, INCM, INAGE and CEDSIF exercising implied oversight and coordination gaps between them (2025-06); a two-tier commission and agency provided for in the draft law (2025-09)	Still provided for in the draft only; no authority established. The World Bank recommended creating one in December 2025 and on 2026-01-16 cut the project subcomponent funding cybersecurity and data protection from US\$18m to US\$11m, stating that operationalising the Data Protection Office had been envisaged over six years and that the remaining project period no longer allows it	STALLED
Personal Data Protection Law (draft)	Draft in preparation, no tabling date (2025-04, World Bank diagnostic)	Still in preparation; the Cabinet submission INTIC planned for June 2026 is not on record, and no tabling or adoption date is stated	STALLED
Personal-data breach reporting platform	Did not exist	Live, taking reports of personal-data breaches, illicit content and cyber incidents	ADVANCED
Notice 4/GGBM/2003 on data-centre location	In force	In force: requires data centres to be located in Mozambique, with offshore replicas only by prior approval; described by the UNECA inception report of June 2025 as part of the scattered rule set standing in for a data-protection statute, alongside article 71 of the Constitution, the Electronic Transactions Law, the Law on Credit Institutions and the Labour Law	NO CHANGE

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Gazette notice withdrawing existing identity documents	Did not exist	Named by the home affairs ministry as the instrument that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older identity documents and current machine-readable cards; not issued	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data-subject rights provisions of the Data Protection Bill	Recorded as removed on a research institute's account; neither draft held	Established from the drafts themselves: the 2020 version carries Part III, "Rights of the Data Subject", sections 8 to 14, together with Part VII on recourse to the judicial authority and Part VIII on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 59-page, eight-Part version the ministry published for comment in March 2022, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations at sections 31 and 32	NO CHANGE

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Haute Autorite de Protection des Donnees a caractere Personnel	Operating	Operating; no caseload or sanction figures published	NO CHANGE
Loi n2022-59 on personal data protection	In force	In force	NO CHANGE
Malabo Convention ratification	Ratified	Ratified	NO CHANGE

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
AI-enabled online gender-based violence tracker	Did not exist	Live, with more than 20,000 verified cases already documented at launch	ADVANCED
America First Global Health Strategy MOU	Did not exist	Signed 2025-12-19; US\$1,953,530,560 planned United States support against Nigeria's US\$2,975,634,499	ADVANCED
Civil-society enforcement against a public body	Did not exist	A Federal High Court suit against the electoral commission	ADVANCED
Federal Government circular on MDA data-protection compliance	Did not exist	Announced by the data-protection commission as Circular No. 59805/S.I/74 of 27 July 2026 directing service-wide compliance, but the document itself is not in the public record: searches of the Secretary to the Government of the Federation's own resource portal by number, keyword and date returned nothing three days after the announcement	ADVANCED
Meta-funded data-protection capacity programme	Did not exist	A two-year programme funded under a court-approved settlement	ADVANCED
NDPC and NCC data-protection MoU	Did not exist	Cooperation between the two regulators	ADVANCED
NDPC enforcement regime	Compliance about 55% (2025-03)	Remediation-first enforcement, compliance above 55%; on 2026-08-13 the commission opened a forensic investigation into a federal university, a bank and a technology vendor over the alleged use of students' personal data to open bank accounts without consent	ADVANCED
NDPC investigations of multinational platforms	Did not exist	Multinational platforms under investigation	ADVANCED
United States-Nigeria Specimen Sharing Agreement	Did not exist	In force 2026-01-18, five-year term renewable once	ADVANCED
MultiChoice data-protection penalty	Imposed (2025-07)	The largest NDPC fine; whether it was paid is not established	NO CHANGE
Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023	In force (2023)	In force; the Commission sits under ministerial control	NO CHANGE

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	Not held	Signed memorandum with activities running 2026-04-01 to 2030-12-31; section 2.5.2 commits Rwanda to negotiate a further 25-year data-sharing arrangement with no data-owner clause or volume cap, unlike Uganda's equivalent instrument	ADVANCED
Data protection and privacy law	In force and in its enforcement phase since October 2023, with no published enforcement record	In force with extraterritorial reach and fines to RWF 5m or 1% of global turnover, still with no enforcement action, fine total or breach register published	NO CHANGE
Data protection appropriation	RWF 130m for 2025/26, down from RWF 150m, with no outturn published	RWF 130m again for 2026/27, with the 2024/25 outturn now known at RWF 52.71m against RWF 150m enacted, 35.1%, all in the first quarter	NO CHANGE
Data-protection supervisory authority	The supervisory authority, budgeted inside the presidency, in an awareness phase	A capacity-building phase with more than a hundred public-sector officers trained, authorising every cross-border transfer	NO CHANGE
Registered data controllers and processors	No registry count published	Still no count of registered controllers or processors, and no enforcement or fine total	NO CHANGE
Privacy compliance score	BASELINE NOT HELD	33% for 2025, level with one neighbour, against 46% for another and a 46% continental average	Baseline not held

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
ANPDP supervision of PReSE registry-CEN data linkage	Did not exist	Oversight role established; assessment to occur after the interconnection is inspected	ADVANCED
Macau DSPDP-ANPDP cooperation MoU	Signing authorised by Macau CE, not yet executed	MoU signed 1 Jun 2026; STP delegation toured Hong Kong Privacy Commissioner and Guangdong cyber-data-security association	ADVANCED
ANPDP membership — Rede Lusofona de Protecção de Dados (RLPD)	Baseline not held	Founding member alongside Portugal (CNPd), Angola, Brazil, Cabo Verde; June-2025 visit addressed disinformation, digital violence, video-surveillance, child/youth data training	NO CHANGE
Malabo Convention — STP signatory status	Baseline not held	Signatory to the AU Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection; ratification status not established	NO CHANGE

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Bill revising the personal data law	Reform reported as in the circuit, awaiting a parliamentary vote, with no text and no timetable	The bill and implementing decree in a finalisation workshop, rewritten against the data and AI strategies; still no adoption date or published text	ADVANCED
Cooperation convention with Benin's protection authority	Did not exist	In force on five pillars: technical and legal capacity, shared regulatory practice, user awareness, cross-border data-flow cooperation and a concerted African position	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Loi n. 2008-12 on personal data	In force and unamended, with the protection commission as regulator	In force and unamended, described by a named expert as outdated against generative AI	NO CHANGE

Seychelles

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Act 2023 (Act 24 of 2023)	Transition already elapsed and Act binding in full at the 2025-08 baseline	Unchanged; no source reports any investigation, audit, fine or guidance issued by the Information Commission since	NO CHANGE
Information Commission (data-protection authority)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Designated authority since Dec 2023; enforcement-capacity gap documented Nov 2025; no audit, investigation or fine against any controller reported to date	Baseline not held

Sierra Leone

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill	No data-protection statute; a draft Bill in consultation (2025-07)	Cabinet approval given and the Bill to be finalised with the Attorney-General and tabled; not enacted, and no parliamentary date set (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Right to Access Information Commission	Operating under the Right to Access Information Commission Act, access to information only (2025-07)	To be transformed into a single authority for both access to information and data protection, with investigative and enforcement powers; awaiting the Bill (2026-04)	ADVANCED

Somalia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-14	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Authority	Inaugurated February 2024 and issuing guidelines, with no enforcement action on record (2025-08)	Requiring all controllers and processors to register and issuing compliance certificates; no penalty issued on record (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Regulatory framework for the public data protection law	Did not exist	Adopted, operationalising the Act and aligning it to the digital transformation agenda (2026-02)	ADVANCED
Request to delay WhatsApp usernames	Did not exist	Request outstanding with no platform response on record; Somalia is the second country after India to ask for a pause (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act (Law 005/2023)	In force, with lawful bases, data-subject rights and fines of 2-4% of worldwide turnover (2025-08)	In force and unamended; the Act does not define public data, which clouds the regulator's mandate (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

South Africa

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Consumer Protection Act direct-marketing opt-out registry	BASELINE NOT HELD	In development (2026-04-20)	Baseline not held
Mandatory breach reporting e-portal	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2025-04-15)	Baseline not held

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Protection of Personal Information Act and Information Regulator	BASELINE NOT HELD	Implemented (2026-07-06)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

South Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Bill	No draft on record	Policy bill drafted with civil-society facilitation; no bill before the Assembly and no statute (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Sudan

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Draft Data and Artificial Intelligence Law	BASELINE NOT HELD	No statute in force and no published text. The justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Data and Artificial Intelligence Regulation Law of 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Certified Data Protection Officer programme	Did not exist	The university trains and assesses and the commission certifies, targeting government, finance, telecommunications, healthcare, education and technology	ADVANCED
Registration and data-protection-officer compliance regime	The registration deadline had expired on 2025-04-30 and commission activity was confined to risk training and awareness	A fresh registration deadline of 2026-04-08 set by ministerial directive, nationwide compliance inspections announced from 2026-04-09, and a seven-day ultimatum to part-registered bodies, with health and education named as still processing unregistered	ADVANCED
Personal Data Protection Act, 2022	In force, with a supervisory commission, a registration duty, a mandatory officer requirement and a breach-notification duty	Unchanged text; no amendment and no new regulations recorded in the window	NO CHANGE
Tax-credential display rule for social-media businesses	Baseline not held	Businesses selling on social media must display tax credentials — a taxpayer identification number, tax clearance certificate or certificate of registration — on their public pages; digital creators and online traders have objected that publishing the credentials exposes them to impersonation and fraud, and no data-protection assessment or redress route is published	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Cooperation accord between the broadcasting and data-protection authorities	Did not exist	In force, its operative mechanism being that the broadcasting authority authorises the data-protection authority to access its control and monitoring room	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Instance de protection des donnees a caractere personnel	Operating from March 2025 on an awareness campaign only, with no certified data-protection officers and no organisation decree	Operating, with thirty-two certified corporate correspondents by June 2026 and a second international forum convened in July 2026; the organisation decree is still not held	ADVANCED
Loi n 2019-014 on the protection of personal data	In force, with the full text not held by the base	In force, with the gazetted text held from 2026-07-20; the article requiring prior authorisation for biometric data and for use of a national identification number is unenforced against the state's own electronic identity programme	NO CHANGE

Tunisia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Draft organic law on personal data protection	Did not exist	123 articles across six titles under committee review, introducing a data protection officer role, obliging public institutions to obtain authorisation for any processing, shifting enforcement to financial penalties through a sanctions department, and naming the press, surveillance cameras, algorithms and cross-border transfers as the uncovered domains; not passed (2026-02)	ADVANCED
National authority for personal data protection	Constituted under the 2004 law, with no enforcement action, decision or annual report held (2025-08)	Unchanged; the sponsors of the replacement bill cite its limited role as the institutional gap the bill exists to close, and it is named in none of the year's new data-concentrating systems (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Organic Law 2004-63 on personal data protection	In force and described by civil society as unfit for the processing the state now does (2025-08)	Still the governing instrument; a 123-article replacement is in committee and has not passed (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Beera Ku Guard awareness campaign	Did not exist (2025-08)	Campaign run; no outcome published against either target as at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Data Protection and Privacy Act, Cap 97	One extraterritorial ruling issued, compliance untested (2025-07-18)	Five corrective orders implemented by a foreign controller, the appeal window expired unused, no fine	ADVANCED
Data Sharing Agreement under the health memorandum	Did not exist	Provided for in the memorandum and not on record as executed: capped at seven years from the memorandum's execution, five over its course and two for reporting, governed jointly by the Joint Health Steering Committee with the Government of Uganda as data owner, requiring prior written authorisation, and binding all data activities to the Data Protection and Privacy Act Cap 97 and the National Data Governance Framework; the State Department briefly posted a subset of the memoranda in March 2026, then removed access and published none of the related agreements, and a suit for their release was unresolved at 2026-04-02	ADVANCED
PDPO decision in AdLegal v WhatsApp and Meta	No decision on file (2025-08)	Five orders complied with inside the 90-day timelines; impact assessment, adequacy assessment, legitimate-interests assessment and a Uganda-specific privacy notice delivered; no appeal, no fine	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
PDPO orders against Google LLC	Orders issued, the 30-day clock running (2025-07-18)	No record of registration, a data-protection officer contact or a transfer-framework filing as at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Be a Cyber Hero child online-safety campaign	Baseline not held	A three-year campaign on child online safety launched in Kampala, led by the ICT ministry with the communications regulator and a private partner; no budget, reach target or evaluation arrangement is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public grasp of data-protection principles	BASELINE NOT HELD	13.6% grasp data-protection principles (2025-12)	Baseline not held

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Act 2021	In force. Project documents describe safeguards as procedural alignment with the Act, and a 2024 account records staff in over 145 offices across ten provinces requiring training on it; civil-society monitoring current to late December 2025 records Cabinet planning to repeal it	Still in force and named by the information ministry on 2026-07-18 as one of three instruments regulating online communications, cybersecurity and personal data; no repeal bill, replacement text, statutory instrument, enforcement action or penalty under the Act is held	NO CHANGE
Office of the Data Protection Commissioner	Operational, with a controller registration deadline of 2025-04-30 recorded by civil-society monitoring; no enforcement action, registration count or annual report held	Unchanged in substance. The Office formed part of a multi-sectoral delegation to the continental identity conference alongside four other institutions, in sessions covering data-protection frameworks for digital identity; no registration count, enforcement decision, fine, breach notification, guidance note or annual report is held at any date. On 2026-07-31 nine civil society organisations asked the Office to examine the source of the contact list behind SMS messages sent to Social Cash Transfer beneficiaries before the 13 August 2026 election; no response from the Office is on the record	NO CHANGE
Transfer of the refugee registration database to the home affairs ministry	Provided for in the refugee and host communities project, board-approved 2024-09-26 and effective 2024-12-23, closing 2028-10-31; the appraisal document records the transfer of the agency database to the ministry on separate servers, and a US\$6m identity limb enrolling refugees into the citizens' register across three districts. The only safeguard described is procedural alignment of departmental operating procedures with the Data Protection Act	Unchanged; no completion, transfer date, data-protection impact assessment, oversight arrangement or implementation status report is held	NO CHANGE

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Licensed data controllers	570 licensed (2025-06-06)	721 licensed (2025-10-15); no figure published since	ADVANCED, NO FIGURE SINCE OCTOBER 2025
National Data Agency	Did not exist	Provided for as an autonomous agency regulating data protection and data sharing, alongside a revision of the data protection act; no instrument, funding or commencement date held, and the communications regulator remains the designated data protection authority	ADVANCED
Privacy responsibility challenge	Did not exist	Launched; no participation figure or outcome held	ADVANCED
Trained data protection officers	More than 500 trained (2025-06-06)	About 1,200 trained (2026-05-14), from 830 at the October 2025 midpoint	ADVANCED
Administrative sanctions under the data protection act	Criminal sanctions only; an enforcement roadmap set fines and criminal action from 2026	Criminal sanctions only, with up to seven years' imprisonment for the accountable chief executive	NO CHANGE
Data protection officer certification	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mandatory certification at US\$1,250 for a Zimbabwean plus a US\$30 application fee, delivered with institutional partners	Baseline not held

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Signatures and ratifications of the Malabo Convention	21 of 55 signed, 20 ratified or acceded and 20 deposited (2026-02-02, the depositary's register)	Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, signed on 2026-07-28 and has not deposited an instrument of ratification	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Malabo Convention	In force, and the continental benchmark against which national data-protection regimes are measured	Unchanged in text; a majority of the Union's 55 members remain outside it twelve years after adoption	NO CHANGE
African Union Data Policy Framework	Baseline not held	In force as the continental reference framework, with about a third of the 54 member states aligned to it on a 2026-08-11 analysis, and 25 national regulatory sandboxes recorded across 15 countries by late 2024; no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
SADC Data Protection Model Law	The 2012 model law, unrevised, with a modernisation consultancy tendered February 2022	Unchanged; no revised text and no outcome of the 2022 revision on record	NO CHANGE

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Supplementary Act on the Protection of Personal Data	The Supplementary Act of February 2010, the regional benchmark national bills were still being drafted against	A revised Act adopted; its text is not published with the communique, so what changed against 2010 is not establishable from the base	ADVANCED

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